



Nitrogen deficiency

If a plant is short of nitrogen, it cannot make enough protein and does not grow properly. It also cannot make enough of the chlorophyll that makes its leaves green, and the edges of its leaves turn pale or even yellow.



Nitrogen-deficient grape leaf

4 Animals, such as cows, eat plants. They digest the plant proteins to make the animal proteins their bodies need.

5 Animal waste, such as dung and urine, returns nitrogen-containing compounds that can be turned into nitrates to the soil.

7 Some kinds of bacteria in the soil turn nitrates back into nitrogen gas, which is released into the air.

6 Some fungi and bacteria living in the soil feed on animal waste, or on the decaying remains of dead animals and plants. They break down nitrogen-containing compounds to release nitrates into the soil.



Decomposing fungi

